The emerging border crisis with China is another political risk for a government so invested in a muscular national-security narrative. The Chinese incursions across the Line of Actual Control (LAC) in Depsang, Pangong Tso, Galwan and Hot Springs emerged as a sort of 'Kargil redux'—as one former military officer put it—by May 2020.[57] Just as Pakistani soldiers surprised India in 1998 by taking over some heights on the Indian side of the Line of Control during a winter break in patrolling, the Chinese took advantage of a pause in regular military exercise due to COVID-19 in early 2020 to take over previously unheld barren areas that had so far only been periodically patrolled by both sides. Unless status quo ante is restored, this could mean a resetting of the LAC by several hundred square kilometres from earlier settled patterns of patrolling. After several soldiers on both sides died in border-fighting for the first time since 1975, Modi denied any loss of territory in a nationally televised address on 19 June 2020. India also made strong military counter-moves of its own after the initial Chinese troop movements, occupying some previously unoccupied areas in that sector, until mutual withdrawals were organised in some areas. While troops disengaged in the Galwan Valley, the north and south sides of the Pangong Lake and Gogra, several other 'friction points' remained until late-2021. So much so that India's ambassador to Beijing publicly listed three 'clear obstacles' blocking progress in talks: the 'need to avoid shifting goalposts', taking a 'one-sided view of concerns and sensitivities, where one's own preoccupations trump any of those flagged by the other side' and 'viewing bilateral relations through the prism of relations with other countries'.[58] By late 2021, both militaries remained deployed in an unprecedented stand-off on border mountain peaks in areas that had never been occupied by either side during winters. New friction points also began to emerge along other parts of the LAC—in Arunachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand.[59] Meanwhile, Modi's government embraced the new Quad grouping of United States, Japan, Australia and India—whose subtext remained China's assertiveness—with its leaders participating in two summits in six months. While the border crisis receded from the headlines, the longer it lingers, the more the chance of escalation and the more difficult the domestic political fallout.